

Fifth Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Quinta Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: ordered love makes sacrifice truthful and fruitful for all

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Connection
Introit	<i>Exaudi, Domine, vocem meam</i> (Ps. 26:7, 9)	Urgent prayer to the saving God	The worshipper begins by seeking the divine face and refusing abandonment, not by rehearsing the grievance against a brother.
Collect	<i>Deus, qui diligentibus te bona invisibilia praeparasti</i>	Infused and ordered love	God is asked to pour his love into the heart so he may be loved in all things and above all things.
Epistle	1 Pet. 3:8–15	Unity, compassion, blessing, peace	Peter gives charity a social form: reject retaliation, govern speech, seek peace, and sanctify Christ in the heart.
Gradual	<i>Protector noster aspice, Deus</i> (Ps. 83:10, 9)	God's searching, protecting gaze	Before Christ searches anger and contempt, the Church places herself under God's searching and protecting gaze.
Alleluia	<i>Domine, in virtute tua laetabitur rex</i> (Ps. 20:1)	Strength, salvation, joy	Peace is sought from received strength rather than the power gained by winning a quarrel.
Gospel	Matt. 5:20–24	Anger, contempt, altar, reconciliation	The altar requires truthful charity: the worshipper who has injured a brother must take the initiative toward reconciliation.
Offertory	<i>Benedicam Dominum</i> (Ps. 15:7–8)	God kept before the eyes	Offering begins by displacing the self-justifying gaze and placing the Lord at the worshipper's right hand.
Communion	<i>Unam petii a Domino</i> (Ps. 26:4)	One desire, one house	Desire for God's house gathers the divided heart toward the communion that resentment contradicts.
Postcommunion	<i>Quos caelesti, Domine, dono satiasti</i>	Hidden cleansing and protection	Those fed by the heavenly gift ask cleansing from hidden faults and freedom from the enemy's snares.

Four Senses of Scripture

Thread	Synthesis
Literal	Matthew moves from murder to anger and contempt, then commands the worshipper whose brother has something against him to seek reconciliation before offering; Peter commands concord, compassion, blessing, disciplined speech, and pursuit of peace.
Allegorical	The altar finds fulfillment in Christ's sacrifice and the Church's Eucharistic offering. Communion in Christ's one body exposes the contradiction of cherishing contempt while receiving the sacrament of unity.
Moral	The hearer must govern speech, refuse retaliation, acknowledge harm done, and take the first truthful and prudent step toward peace; reconciliation does not require denial of wrong or unsafe contact.
Anagogical	Ordered love and reconciled worship prepare the soul for the one house and final vision of God, where contempt cannot enter and communion is complete.

Core Scriptural Symbols

Thread	Synthesis
Altar and Gift	Chrysostom, <i>Homily 16 on Matthew</i> , stresses that the gift is not received before reconciliation. The altar does not make ritual unimportant; its holiness makes charity indispensable to a truthful offering.
Brother	Augustine, <i>On the Sermon on the Mount</i> I.10.26, distinguishes a brother's grievance caused by our injury from an injury done to us, which calls for forgiveness. This sharpens responsibility without pretending every conflict is symmetrical.
Tongue	Peter's command to restrain the tongue from evil joins Christ's warnings against <i>raca</i> and <i>fatue</i> . Speech is where inward contempt becomes social injury, and blessing is where retaliatory habit begins to be converted.
House of the Lord	Editorial synthesis: the Communion's one desire counters the heart divided into many chambers of grievance. The Postcommunion immediately guards against presumption by asking cleansing from faults still hidden.

Patristic Exegesis of the Grouped Propers

Thread	Synthesis
1. Introit	Text/function: Psalm 26 cries for a hearing, a helper, and the saving God. Editorial reading: injury is first carried into prayer, interrupting retaliation and exposing the need for divine aid.
2. Collect	Text/function: God is asked to infuse love so that he may be loved in all and above all, unto promises beyond desire. Placement: reconciliation begins not in vague civility but in divinely given, rightly ordered charity.
3. Epistle	Text/function: 1 Peter 3 commands concord, compassion, humility, blessing, disciplined speech, and pursued peace. Diagnosis: anger becomes a pattern of return—evil for evil and insult for insult—unless Christ is sanctified in the heart.

Thread	Synthesis
4. Gradual	Text/function: <i>Protector noster aspice, Deus</i> (Ps. 83:10, 9) asks God to look upon and hear his servants. Placement: before Christ looks into anger and contempt, the Church willingly places herself under God's searching and protecting gaze.
5. Alleluia	Text/function: <i>Domine, in virtute tua laetabitur rex</i> (Ps. 20:1) locates joy in God's strength and salvation. Editorial reading: peace is sought from received strength rather than the power gained by winning a quarrel.
6. Gospel	Text/function: Matthew 5 exposes anger and contempt as roots of violence and commands reconciliation before the gift. Patristic control: Chrysostom sees the delayed gift as Christ's earnest destruction of root and fruit; Augustine specifies responsibility for injury one has caused.
7. Offertory	Text/function: Psalm 15 blesses the Lord for counsel and keeps God always in sight. Placement: the worshipper offers a gaze being freed from self-vindication and reordered toward divine judgment and counsel.
8. Secret	Text/function: <i>Propitiare, Domine, supplicationibus nostris</i> asks God to receive the offerings so that what each has offered to his name may profit all unto salvation. Hinge: private gifts are ordered to a common good; cherished resentment contradicts the offering's explicitly ecclesial fruit.
9. Communion	Text/function: Psalm 26 names the one desire to dwell in the Lord's house. Placement: the many claims of grievance yield to the one communion for which the heart was made.
10. Postcommunion	Text/function: those satisfied by the heavenly gift ask cleansing from hidden faults and release from hostile snares. Final effect: Communion deepens examination and dependence rather than certifying the communicant's innocence.

Grouped instruction (editorial synthesis). The Mass takes an afflicted worshipper from urgent prayer into infused charity; disciplines retaliation through Peter; submits anger, speech, and responsibility to Christ at the altar; and makes each person's offering serve the salvation of all. Communion gathers desire into God's one house while the final prayer continues the work of hidden cleansing.

Exegetical Notes

- The Collect asks for love, not fear: its logic is infusion, right order, and fulfillment in promises beyond every desire.
- Matthew says that the brother has something against the worshipper. The text especially addresses harm one has caused, while 1 Peter also governs one's response when suffering harm.
- The Secret converts a private reconciliation theme into ecclesiology: what each offers is asked to profit everyone unto salvation.

Patristic and Sainly Witnesses

Witness	Text / source status	Interpretive contribution
St. John Chrysostom, <i>Homily 16 on Matthew</i>	Direct quotation: "He receives not the gift before the reconciliation, indicating great displeasure."	Shows that reconciliation belongs to truthful sacrifice because the altar matters, not because ritual is dispensable.

Witness	Text / source status	Interpretive contribution
St. Augustine, <i>On the Sermon on the Mount</i> I.10.26	Direct quotation: “We are therefore to proceed to reconciliation, when it has occurred to our mind that we have perhaps injured our brother in something.”	Controls the call to initiative by attending to the text’s direction of responsibility.
St. John Chrysostom, <i>Homily 16 on Matthew</i>	Paraphrase: Christ attacks both anger’s root and reviling’s fruit and adds urgency so delay cannot protect enmity.	Gives the homilist a progression from interior anger through speech to prompt action.

Homiletic Synthesis

Thread	Synthesis
Proposition	God infuses the charity that makes sacrifice truthful, turning private grievance into peace ordered to the salvation of the whole Church.
Movement I – gift	God hears, helps, pours love into the heart, supplies strength for peace, and prepares one house and one heavenly gift.
Movement II – resistance	Anger justifies itself, contempt hardens into speech, retaliation mirrors the injury, and worship is used to evade responsibility toward the brother.
Movement III – sacramental conversion	The altar interrupts evasion; the Offertory reorders the gaze, the Secret directs each gift to everyone’s salvation, and Communion gathers divided desire into Christ’s one body.
Final horizon	Take the first truthful and safe step toward repair, seek counsel when contact would be imprudent, and let present peace prepare the soul for unbroken communion in God’s house.

Preaching Applications

- Distinguish reconciliation from pretending no wrong occurred: apology, restitution, boundaries, forgiveness, and restored trust are related but not identical acts.
- Invite examination of contemptuous speech and remembered injury, not only visible outbursts of anger.
- Recommend a concrete next step—apology, restitution, intercessory prayer, or qualified counsel. Where abuse, coercion, or danger is present, direct contact may be unsafe and is not demanded by a simplistic reading of the text.

Primary References

- *Missale Romanum* (1962), *Dominica Quinta post Pentecosten*; local OCR temporal corpus. Latin OCR remains to be checked against a printed missal before publication.
- St. John Chrysostom, *Homilies on Matthew*, Homily 16, on Matt. 5:17–26, [NPNF working English translation](#).
- St. Augustine, *On the Sermon on the Mount* I.10.26, [NPNF working English translation](#).

Full Patristic and Saintly Texts

- St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 16 on Matthew*: “He receives not the gift before the reconciliation, indicating great displeasure.”
- St. Augustine, *On the Sermon on the Mount* I.10.26: “We are therefore to proceed to reconciliation, when it has occurred to our mind that we have perhaps injured our brother in something.”